

- ◆ 2012 : Oculus Rift launches on Kickstarter and surpasses its goal to achieve almost \$800,000 in pledges.
- ◆ January 2014: Oculus demonstrates a more finished prototype, the Crystal Cove at CES 2014 with features like external position tracking and very low latency.
- ◆ March 2014: Sony announces Project Morpheus VR headset for Playstation.
- ◆ April 2014 : Facebook purchases Oculus Rift for nearly \$2 billion. Virtuix raises more than \$3 million to develop its omnidirectional treadmill.
- ◆ June 2014 : Google launches the Cardboard initiative, offering a cheap, easy-to-use and open platform for VR in everybody's smartphone.
- ◆ March 2015 : HTC unveils Vive, its VR headset made in collaboration with Valve, to be launched commercially in April 2016.
- ◆ July 2015 : OnePlus became the first company to launch a product, their flagship smartphone OnePlus 2, on Virtual reality using OnePlus cardboard, based on Google cardboard.
- ◆ January 6, 2016 : Oculus Rift consumer edition opens for pre-orders for its March 28 launch.



WHAT IS RESPONSE TIME?

A display's response time is the time it takes (measured in milliseconds) for the individual pixels to change state. This is usually benchmarked against its ability to switch a pixel from black to white or transition from one shade of grey to another. This is an important metric that determines the efficacy with which the TV/monitor will be able to handle fast motion characterised in action films and videogames.

Good HMD, Bad HMD

As it is evident from the time line earlier, a number of virtual reality Head mounted displays are already in the hands of users, mostly in the form of development kits. With so many options and more yet to come, what should you really look for in a VR HMD? Don't worry, we've got you covered with this list of features that a typically good VR headset has:

Field of View: A greater field of view offers a greater sense of immersion. Although human field of view is 180°, most headsets do not offer that much.

Resolution: HMD's can list their resolution in two ways, either the full resolution of the screen, or as the pixel density, expressed in pixels per